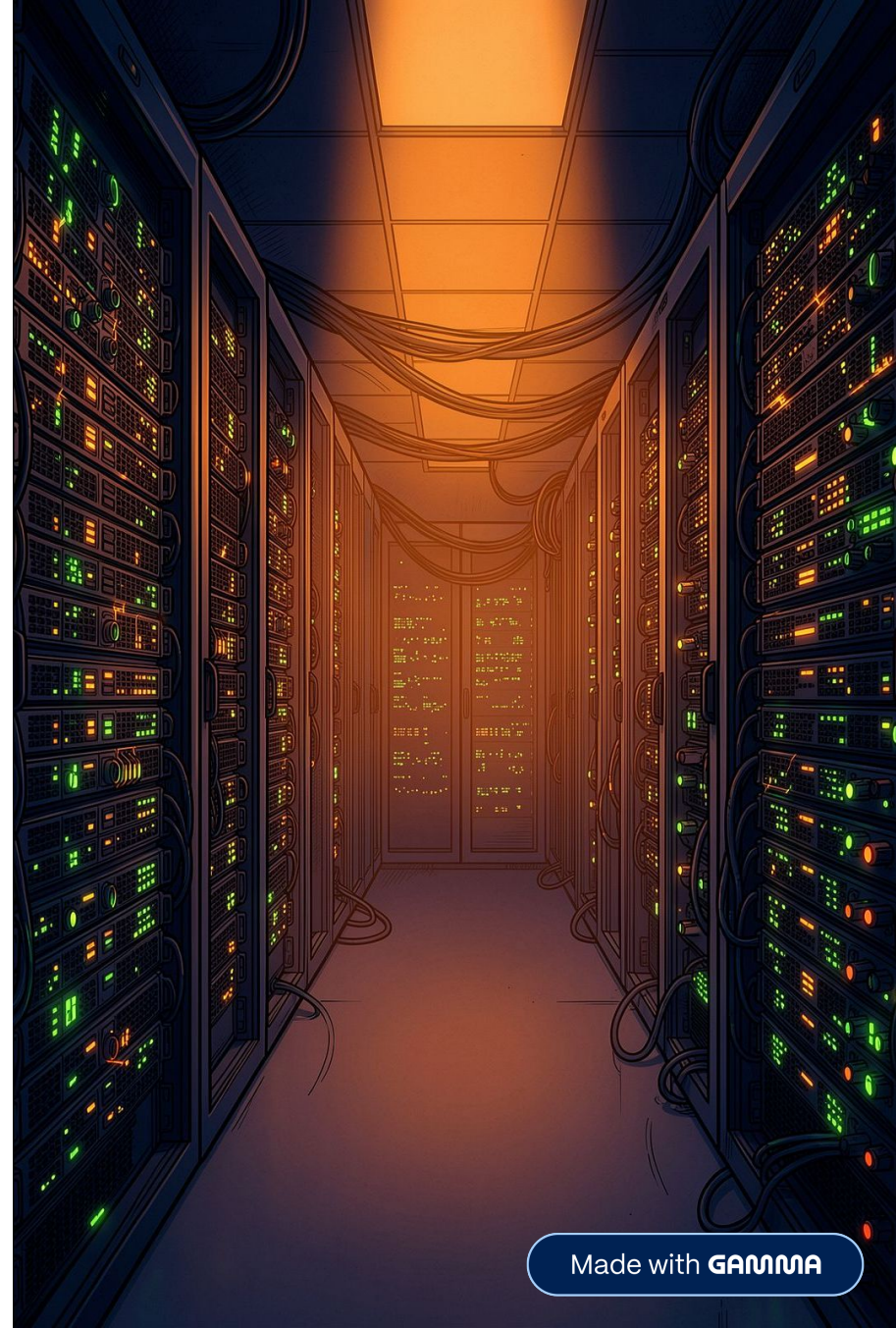


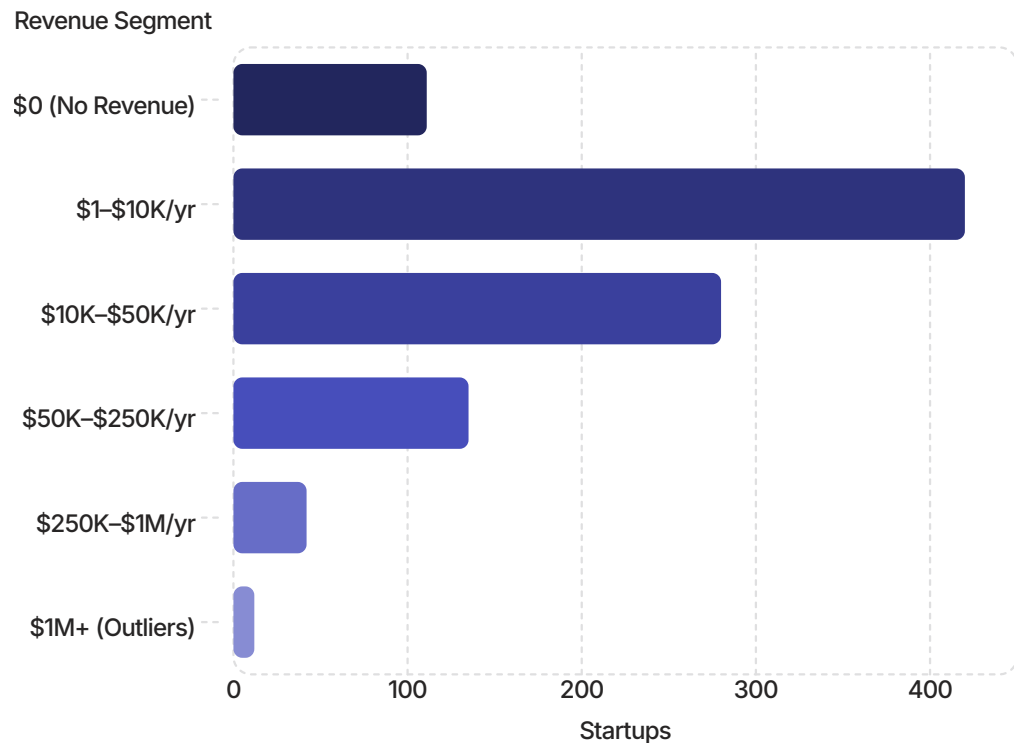
The Power-Law Economy of Indie SaaS

1,000 startups. \$270M+ in combined revenue. One brutal pattern.

TRUSTMRR · N=1,000 · FROZEN 30 JUL 2026



The median startup makes \$3,069/year. The average makes \$133,750.



Power-Law, Not Bell Curve

A handful of outliers — **Stan (\$25M)**, Supliful (\$10.6M), Stack Influence (\$10.5M) — distort the average beyond recognition. The median tells the real story.

□ This is a winner-take-most market. The average is a lie.



1 in 9 listed startups makes \$0.

111

Zero-Revenue Listings

11% of the dataset — listed, visible,
earning nothing

\$0

Annual Revenue

Yet still counted in the dataset
average

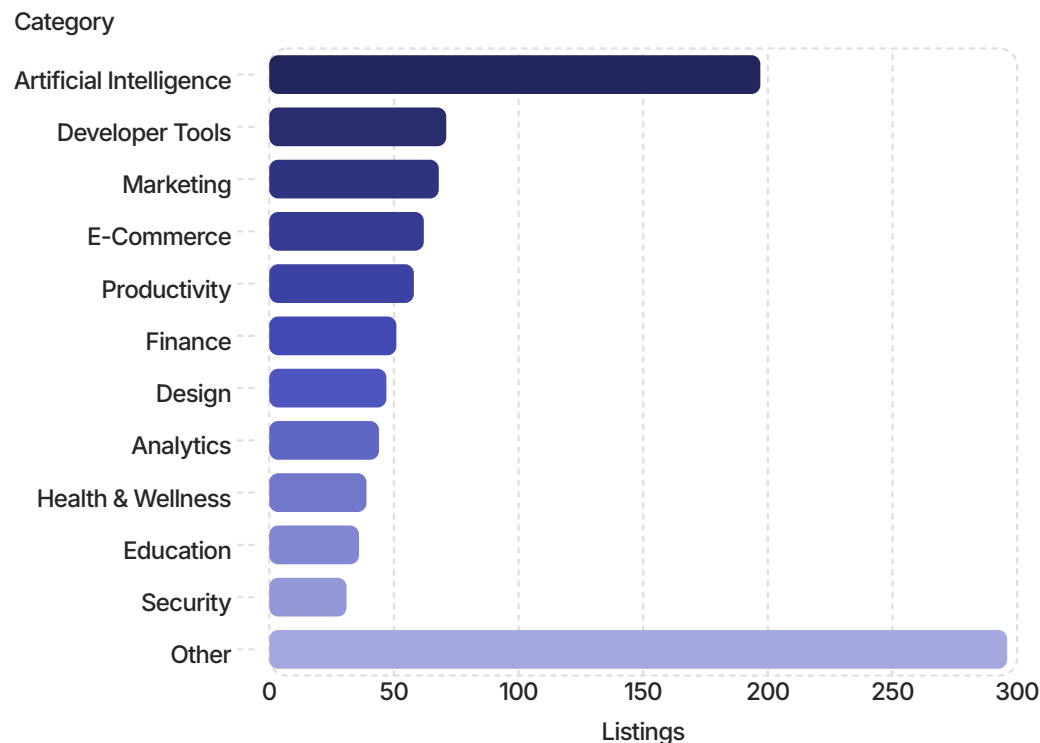
11%

Of All Listings

TrustMRR is as much a graveyard as
a leaderboard

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AI ate the indie-startup world.



The Wrapper Gold Rush

AI commands **197 listings** — nearly **3×** the next category.

Everyone built the same wrapper at the same time, chasing the same wave.

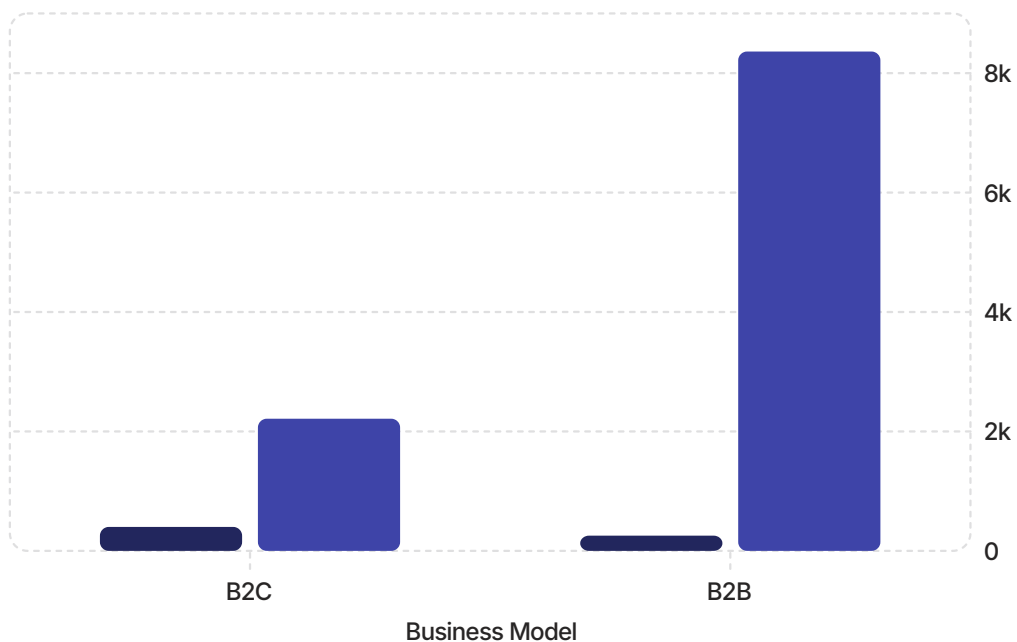
□ Saturation compresses margins. Differentiation is the only moat left.

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B2B has fewer players but wins on money.

■ Number of Listings

■ Median Revenue (\$/yr)



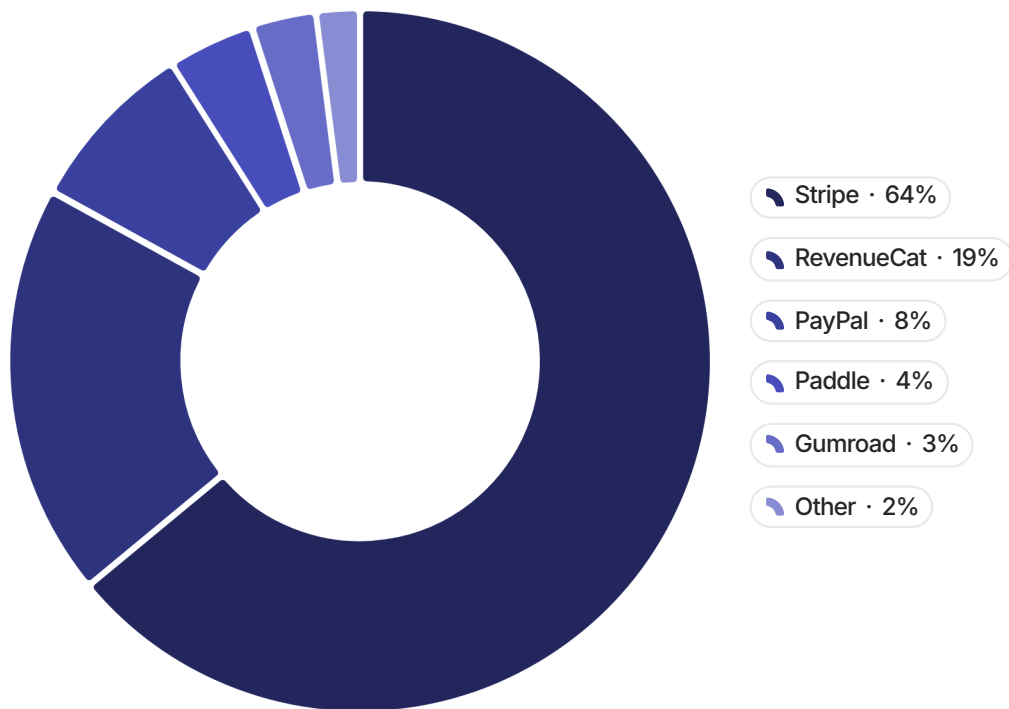
More Shots ≠ More Revenue

B2C has **401 listings** vs. B2B's 255 — yet B2B's median revenue of **\$8,362** is **4× B2C's \$2,213**. Fewer players, bigger wallets, better unit economics.

□ The B2B premium is real — and it's not closing.

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Stripe owns the rails. RevenueCat owns mobile.



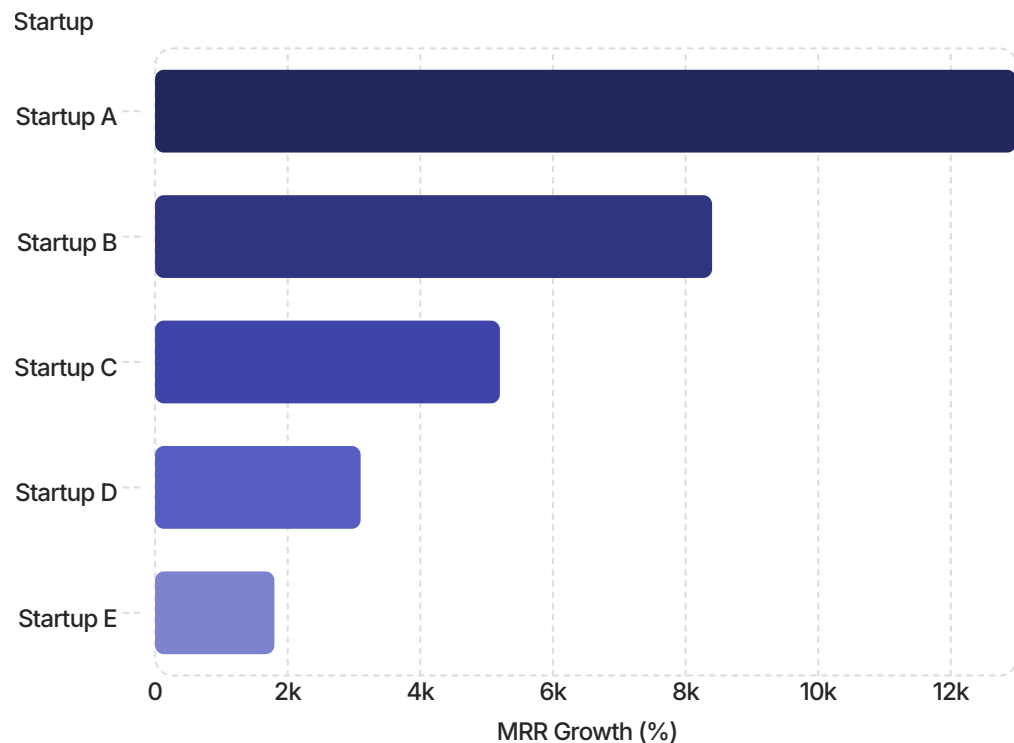
Payment Stack = Company Type

Stripe's **64% dominance** reflects web-first SaaS.

RevenueCat's 19% clusters tightly around mobile-IAP indie apps — a clear signal of business model, not just payment preference.

□ The money rails reveal the architecture before you read a single line of code.

The biggest "growth" numbers are illusions.



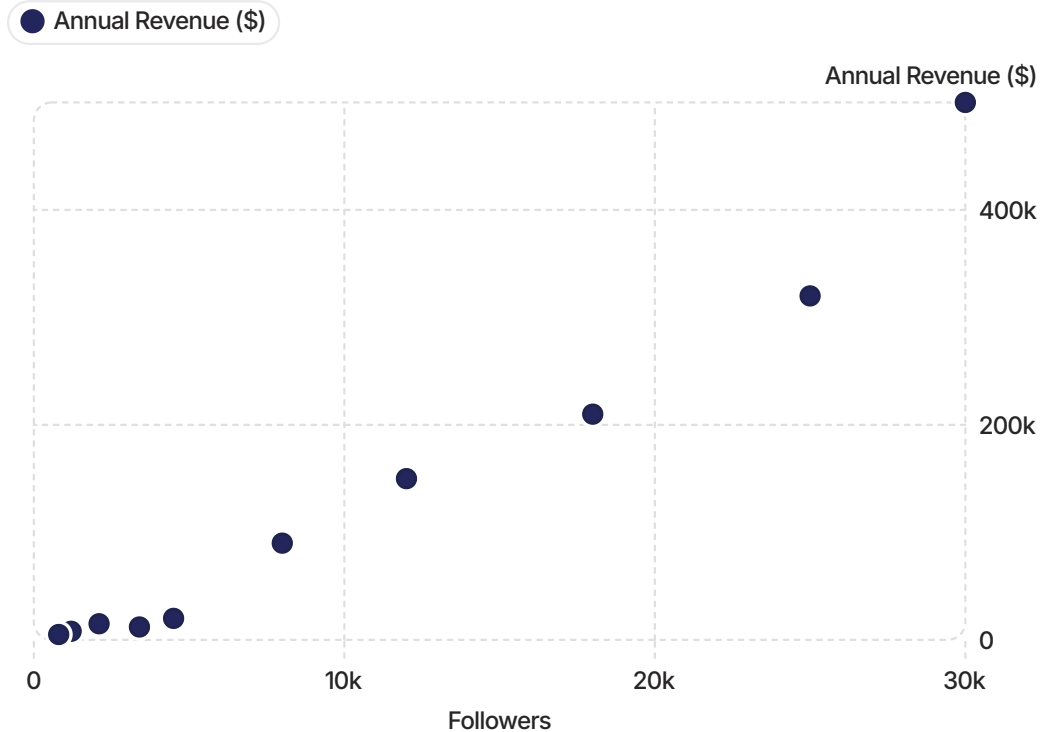
Always Filter by a Revenue Floor

12,983% growth sounds explosive — until you see the base was **\$54 MRR**. A \$50→\$2,000 jump is a rounding error, not a trend.



Growth% without an absolute revenue floor is a vanity metric. Always check the base.

26% are for sale, priced at a median 2.3× revenue.



The Real Winners Aren't Selling

For-sale listings cluster at **mid-tier revenue** — not the top. The 2.3× multiple is honest pricing for a struggling asset, not a premium exit.

□ If you're winning, you hold. The marketplace is a distress signal.



Indie SaaS isn't a level playing field — it's a lottery with very good infrastructure.

\$3,069

Median Annual Revenue

Half the dataset earns less than this

20%

AI Category Saturation

One in five listings — same wave, same time

2.3×

Exit Multiple

What the market pays — when you can sell at all

74%

Never List for Sale

The ones still playing — or already won

The house always wins. The infrastructure is world-class. The odds are not.

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